

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

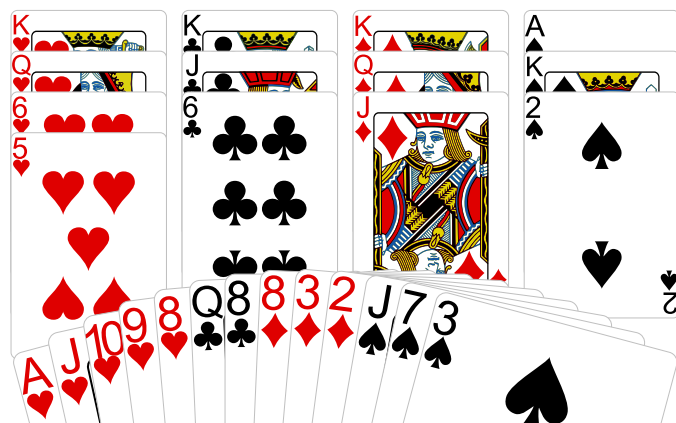
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

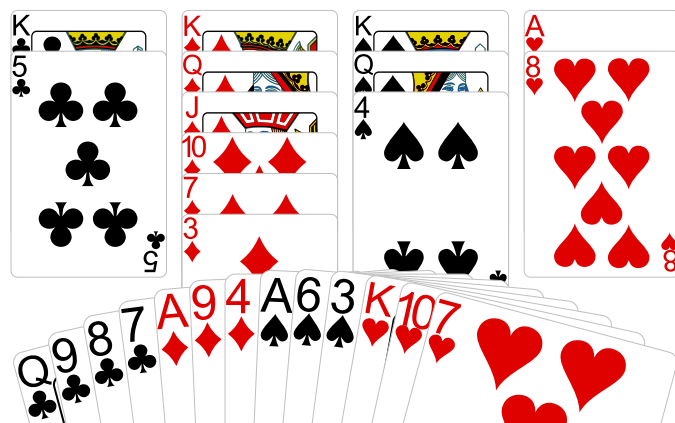
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 5♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: West

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6
♥ 7 2
♦ 5 4
♣ A 9 4 3 2

8
6 4
22

♠ J 7 3
♥ A J T 9 8
♦ 8 3 2
♣ Q 8



♠ A K 2
♥ K Q 6 5
♦ K Q J
♣ K J 6

♠ T 5 4
♥ 4 3
♦ A T 9 7 6
♣ T 7 5

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SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6



when she hears NORTH's positive

response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by North			

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ K Q J T 7 3
 ♣ K 5

6
 18 13
 3

♠ T 9 7
 ♥ Q 6 5 3
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ A 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 5 2
 ♥ J 9 4 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ J T 6 2

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ K T 7
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ Q 9 8 7

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4 ♣	Pass	4 ♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 6

WEST not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners.

So when EAST jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, WEST uses Gerber.

EAST shows two Aces so WEST decides 6NT will be just right.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 4 2
♣ T 9 8 6 3 2

13
5 3
19

♠ K Q 8 5
♥ J 6 3
♦ 8 7
♣ A Q J 4



♠ A J 9 6 3
♥ A 4
♦ A Q J 6
♣ K 5

♠ T 7 2
♥ T 9 7 2
♦ K T 9 5 3
♣ 7

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

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When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally

turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT.

NORTH's 5

♦

answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces

must be the ♣A.

SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Deal 4

East Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ -

4
8 23
5

♠ 5 2
♥ 6
♦ A 6 5 4
♣ T 9 8 6 5 4



♠ T 9 8 7 3
♥ 5 3 2
♦ T 7
♣ A J 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A K T
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by West			

EAST bids 6

♥

, knowing they must lose the

♦

A.

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EAST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn,
but WEST gives a positive 2

♥

response and his thinking changes! First he
supports

♥

s, setting the

trump suit.

WEST then bids 3♠, showing first round
control. EAST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and

WEST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and
one Ace, obviously the ♠A.